

Glossary of Orderflow and Platform Terms

Concepts | beginner | 7 min read | DeepCharts Help Center | July 15, 2026

Every specialist field compresses its ideas into shorthand, and orderflow trading is worse than most. This page defines the terms used across the DeepCharts Help Center in one or two sentences each, grouped by theme, with a link to the article that explains each idea properly.

Use it as a lookup, not a course — the linked articles carry the substance. If you are starting from zero, read Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta first and return here whenever a term stops you.

How to use this glossary

Terms are grouped into five sections: orderflow basics, footprint and imbalance, profiles and auction structure, market structure and data, and platform terms. Within each group, related terms sit next to each other so you can read a group top to bottom as a micro-primer.

Orderflow basics

- **Orderflow** — The study of the actual orders behind price movement: executed trades, their aggressor side, and the resting liquidity they trade into. Foundation article: Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta.
- **Bid** — The highest price at which resting buyers are currently willing to buy. A trade printing at the bid was initiated by an aggressive seller.
- **Ask (offer)** — The lowest price at which resting sellers are currently willing to sell. A trade printing at the ask was initiated by an aggressive buyer.
- **Spread** — The gap between the best bid and the best ask; in liquid futures such as ES it is usually one tick.
- **Limit order** — A resting order to buy or sell at a stated price or better; limit orders make up the book that aggressors trade into.
- **Market order** — An order that executes immediately against whatever is resting at the best available price, crossing the spread to do so.
- **Aggressor** — The impatient side of a trade — the participant whose market order crossed the spread. Orderflow tools classify every trade by its aggressor; see Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta.
- **Delta** — Ask-traded volume minus bid-traded volume for a bar: the net balance of aggression. Plotted per bar by Delta Bar and Deep Delta.
- **Cumulative delta** — Each bar's delta added to a running session total, used to compare the trend of aggression against the trend of price. See Delta Cumulative Candlestick.
- **Delta divergence** — Price making a new extreme that cumulative delta does not confirm (or vice versa) — a disagreement between effort and result worth attention.
- **Liquidity** — The resting orders available to trade against. A liquid price absorbs large orders with little movement; an illiquid one moves on small orders.
- **Tape (Time and Sales)** — The raw chronological list of every executed trade with its price, size and side. In DeepCharts this is the Advanced Time And Sales window.
- **Speed of tape** — How fast trades are printing — a proxy for urgency and participation. Measured by the Speed of Tape indicator.
- **Sweep** — A single aggressive order large enough to consume multiple price levels of resting liquidity at once. Large aggressive prints are isolated by Big Trades.
- **Iceberg** — A large limit order that displays only a small portion at a time, automatically reloading as it fills so its true size stays hidden. See Understanding Icebergs and Absorption.

- **Absorption** — Heavy aggressive volume that fails to move price because a large passive player is taking the other side — often the earliest visible sign of a reversal. See Understanding Icebergs and Absorption.
- **Exhaustion** — A move running out of participants: shrinking volume and aggression as price presses to a new extreme, leaving it vulnerable to reversal.
- **Initiative vs responsive** — Initiative activity attacks away from established value (breakout buying above value); responsive activity defends value (buying a dip back to it). Framework article: Understanding Auction Theory: Imbalance, Unfinished Auctions, Absorption.

Footprint and imbalance

- **Footprint** — A chart style that opens each bar to show traded volume at every price, split into bid-traded and ask-traded. Concept and reading practice: Reading a Footprint: Worked Examples; the DeepCharts indicator is Deep Print (Footprint).
- **Imbalance** — A footprint cell where one side's volume exceeds the other's by a set ratio, compared diagonally (ask volume at a price versus bid volume one tick below). Detected by Imbalance Tracker.
- **Stacked imbalance** — Several imbalances on consecutive prices in the same direction — a zone where one side was overwhelmed, often acting as support or resistance on revisit. See Reading a Footprint: Worked Examples.
- **Unfinished auction** — A bar or swing extreme that traded on both bid and ask (no zero print), suggesting the auction at that price never completed; such levels are common revisit candidates. Flagged by the Unfinished Auction indicator.

Profiles and auction structure

- **TPO (Time Price Opportunity)** — The building block of Market Profile: each price gets one mark per time bracket it traded in, so the profile shows where the market spent *time*. See Market Profile (TPO) and the Profile Chart Window (TPO and Volume Profiles).
- **Single print** — In a TPO profile, a price visited during only one time bracket — a mark of rapid, unaccepted movement that traders watch for later revisits.
- **POC (Point of Control)** — The single price with the most traded volume (or most TPOs) in a period — the market's consensus fair price. Concept: Understanding Volume Profile: POC, Value Area, HVN/LVN; tracked live by Dynamic POC.
- **Naked POC** — A prior session's POC that price has not traded back through since — a commonly watched future target.
- **Value area (VA), VAH, VAL** — The price band around the POC containing a set share of the period's volume (about 70% by convention); its edges are the Value Area High and Value Area Low. See Understanding Volume Profile: POC, Value Area, HVN/LVN.
- **HVN / LVN (high / low volume node)** — Secondary volume peaks (prices the market kept returning to) and the thin valleys between them (prices it rejected quickly). LVNs tend to be traversed fast; HVNs slow price down.
- **VWAP** — The Volume Weighted Average Price of the session: the average price paid, weighted by size, usually drawn with standard-deviation bands. See Understanding VWAP and VWAP Envelopes.

Market structure, contracts and data

- **RTH / ETH** — Regular Trading Hours (the main daytime session) versus Electronic Trading Hours (the full, nearly 24-hour session). Concept: Understanding Market Structure and Sessions (RTH/ETH, Rollover); the chart toggle lives in Chart Display Options (Bar Styles, Sessions, Countdown).
- **Session** — A defined trading period (RTH, overnight, or a custom window) used to anchor profiles, VWAP and daily statistics; custom windows are set in Price Chart Settings.

- **Front month** — The contract month where the volume currently lives — the one you should chart and trade.
- **Rollover** — Switching from the expiring futures contract to the next one as volume migrates ahead of expiry. In DeepCharts: Symbol Rollover (Change Contract Month).
- **Continuous contract** — A long chart history stitched together across contract months; adjusted modes remove the artificial price step at each roll. Setting reference: Price Chart Settings.
- **EOD (end-of-day) data** — Historical daily data loaded without a live streaming feed, useful for reviewing past price action. See Connect Historical Data (End of Day).
- **Tick / volume / range bars** — Bar types that close after a set number of trades, a set traded volume, or a set price range, instead of after a fixed time. Configured in Price Chart Settings.
- **Level 1 vs Level 2** — Level 1 data carries trades and the best bid/ask only; Level 2 adds the depth ladder of resting orders at prices beyond the best. The DOM and depth features need Level 2 — see Advanced DOM Window.
- **MBO vs MBP** — Two Level 2 formats: Market By Order delivers every individual resting order (heavier, best for orderflow tools), Market By Price delivers only per-level totals (lighter on bandwidth). The choice appears as **DOM Type** in dxFeed connections — see How to Connect a dxFeed Data Feed.
- **DOM (Depth of Market)** — The ladder of resting bid and ask liquidity at each price. In DeepCharts: the Advanced DOM Window window and the Depth of Market (DOM) Indicator indicator.

Platform terms

- **Template** — One chart's saved configuration — indicators, styles, settings — reloadable on any chart. See Templates and Workspaces; the built-in one-click presets are covered in Quick Chart Templates (OF-VP, D-VP, W-VP...).
- **Workspace** — Your entire saved screen layout: multiple windows, charts and their configurations. See Templates and Workspaces.
- **Sim account** — A simulation account on the built-in **SIM** broker that fills orders against live chart data without real money. See Trading Accounts and Simulation.
- **Prop firm** — A proprietary trading firm that funds traders on its own capital, typically via an evaluation; prop-firm accounts connect to DeepCharts through feeds such as Rithmic or dxFeed. See Supported Brokers, Prop Firms and Data Feeds and Connect Any Rithmic Prop-Firm Account (Server Table).
- **Data feed** — The market-data connection that streams prices into the platform; every chart needs one. Setup overview: How to Connect a Data Feed (Feed Settings).

Related articles

- Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta
- Understanding Volume Profile: POC, Value Area, HVN/LVN
- Understanding Auction Theory: Imbalance, Unfinished Auctions, Absorption
- Understanding Market Structure and Sessions (RTH/ETH, Rollover)
- Reading a Footprint: Worked Examples
- Welcome to DeepCharts: Platform Tour